

Sagnik Kumar Gupta

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EDUCATION

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| Ph.D. (Development Studies) , Indian Institute of Technology Hyderabad | 2024–Present |
| M.Sc. (Population Studies & Health Economics) , Gokhale Institute of Politics and Economics, Maharashtra, India | 2021–2023 |
| B.Sc. (Economics Honours) , University of Calcutta, West Bengal, India | 2018–2021 |

WORKING PAPERS

- **Rewiring Gender Norms: Causal Evidence on Internet Exposure and Justification of Intimate Partner Violence** (with Dr. Gaurav Dhamija and Dr. Manini Ojha)

Abstract: This paper evaluates the causal impact of women’s exposure to the internet on their attitudes towards intimate partner violence (IPV) using data from the most recent round of the National Family Health Survey (NFHS-5). To address potential endogeneity, we exploit exogenous variation in district-level mobile tower density in India as an instrument for women’s internet exposure. The instrumental variables estimation provides robust evidence that a woman’s exposure to internet reduces her likelihood of justifying IPV by 21 percentage points. We also provide suggestive evidence that higher awareness and physical mobility are potential mechanisms through which internet exposure shapes attitudes. Our findings highlight the transformative potential of digital connectivity in challenging regressive gender norms.

- **The Protective Power of Connectivity: Internet Exposure and Intimate Partner Violence** (with Dr. Gaurav Dhamija and Dr. Manini Ojha)

Abstract: We study the effect of women’s exposure to the internet on the incidence of intimate partner violence (IPV) utilizing data from a large-scale nationally representative data for India. Utilizing an instrumental variable approach, we exploit the exogenous variation arising from cellular tower density at the district level as an instrument for internet exposure. We find women who have access to the internet are at a significantly lower risk of exposure to physical, sexual, emotional and any IPV by 17, 5, 9 and 18 percentage points. We provide further indicative evidence that women’s attitudes justifying violence works as a channel of our estimated causal impacts. Our results are robust to a host of sensitivity checks, additional controls, alternative definitions and falsification analysis. We document important heterogeneity in the effects across social groups, wealth index, area of residence, and women’s education levels. The effects appear to be particularly important for women who are more educated and for those belonging to the backward social groups.

- **Banking on Connectivity: Internet Exposure and Women’s Financial Autonomy**
(with Dr. Gaurav Dhamija and Dr. Manini Ojha)

Abstract: We examine whether women’s exposure to the internet enhances their economic agency in India. Using nationally representative data and an instrumental variables strategy that exploits plausibly exogenous variation in district-level mobile tower density, we identify the causal effect of internet access on women’s financial control and use of formal banks. We find that internet exposure increases women’s overall financial autonomy by 10 percentage points. We document improvements in independent mobility, employment, and financial awareness which we consider potential mechanisms of our estimated effects. Disaggregated outcomes show higher likelihood that women have money of their own over which they full control, as well as increased ownership and active use of a bank account. Our results are robust to additional controls and a battery of sensitivity analyses. Heterogeneity analyses indicate that effects are concentrated among women with at least secondary education, and among those from historically disadvantaged social groups. Overall, our findings highlight the importance of digital connectivity in enhancing the usage of financial resources, with important implications for women’s autonomy and participation in the formal economy.

WORK IN PROGRESS

- **Knot Too Early: The Causal Impact of Women’s Age at Marriage on Period Product Usage in India**
- **Causal Impact of Internet Exposure on Period Products Usage in India**

CONFERENCE PAPER PRESENTATIONS

- International Economic Association World Congress, Belgrade 2026
- Second CDS PhD Colloquium – Crossroads 2026
- 7th Annual Conference of Economics & Finance (ACEF), BITS Pilani, Hyderabad Campus
- 7th Annual Economics Conference, Ahmedabad University
- 35th Annual Conference on Development Economics, Jadavpur University
- XXX IIPS National Seminar, Thiruvananthapuram (2025)
- “Two Days National Conference on Women @ 75: Work, Life and Freedom, 2023” – ICSSR, UNICEF, and NIT Rourkela.
- “Graduate Research Meet” – School of Liberal Arts, IIT Jodhpur.
- XXI Bhopal Seminar 2023 – Contemporary Issues in Demography and Development in India.
- D.R. Gadgil Memorial Paper Presentation 2023 – Gokhale Institute of Politics and Economics.

FELLOWSHIP

- Ministry of Education Fellowship – Government of India July 2024- July 2029
- Qualified for Assistant Professor – University Grants Commission June 2023
National Eligibility Test (UGC–NET) December 2023

TECHNICAL SKILLS

STATA, QGIS, MS Office, LaTeX

LANGUAGES

English , Bengali , Hindi